Daniel Smith

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Summary

Reliability and platform engineer with 6+ years at YouTube (Google) and 10+ years building production software. Builds Kubernetes and Helm platforms, privacy-focused AI infrastructure, and accessible full-stack products, with strengths in release engineering, operational automation, and incident response.

Skills

Languages & Data: Python, Go, TypeScript/JavaScript, SQL, C++, Bash, BigQuery/GoogleSQL
Platform & Delivery: Kubernetes, k3s, Helm, Docker/OCI, Linux, GitHub Actions, GHCR, Cloudflare, Google Cloud
Reliability: SLOs, monitoring and alerting, dashboards, incident response, on-call, capacity and reliability reviews, runbooks, CI/CD, release engineering, automated testing
Application & AI: Astro, Svelte, React, Vite, Flask, REST and OpenAI-compatible APIs, Three.js/WebGL, local LLM inference, LLM application and infrastructure engineering

Experience

Independent Open Source Engineering — Remote
Platform & Reliability Engineer — Jun 2025 – Present

- Maintain and evolve Sugarkube, a reusable k3s and Helm platform for Raspberry Pi and SBC clusters, with automated image provisioning, environment-specific deployments, health verification, rollback paths, and recovery runbooks.
- Standardized release engineering across DSPACE, token.place, and danielsmith.io using GHCR container images, OCI Helm charts, immutable commit tags, staged promotion, and post-deployment verification.
- Developed token.place, a privacy-focused distributed AI platform with OpenAI-compatible APIs, local model inference, end-to-end encrypted relay flows, multi-relay failover, rate limiting, and cross-language security and integration testing.
- Integrated DSPACE chat with token.place and shipped accessible Astro/Svelte and TypeScript/Three.js applications with offline behavior, SSR safeguards, WebGL-to-text failover, and automated browser testing.

YouTube (Google) — San Bruno, CA
Site Reliability Engineer, L4 — Sep 2018 – May 2025

- Defined product-health metrics and leadership dashboards for high-traffic YouTube surfaces, giving product and engineering teams a shared basis for reliability reviews and prioritization.
- Automated monitoring, anomaly analysis, and operational workflows in Python, Go, SQL, and C++, improving signal quality and reducing repetitive investigation for large-scale production systems.
- Served on-call across Core, Trust & Safety, and Search SRE; handled incidents and partnered with service owners to turn failure modes into runbooks, readiness checks, and follow-up improvements.
- Advised teams across Alphabet on reliability metrics and review practices; authored reusable playbooks, mentored engineers, strengthened onboarding, and earned promotion to L4 in Dec 2021.

Naval Research Laboratory — Stennis Space Center, MS
Software Engineer — Jan 2017 – Sep 2018

- Built C++/Qt data-processing applications for research workflows and delivered iterative releases, demonstrations, and documentation in a distributed Scrum team.

The University of Southern Mississippi — Hattiesburg, MS
Software Developer — Mar 2014 – Dec 2016

- Built an Objective-C content-delivery and networking framework for university iOS applications, supporting real-time content updates.

Education

The University of Southern Mississippi - M.S. Computer Science, *GPA: 4.0* — Aug 2015 – Aug 2016
The University of Southern Mississippi - B.S. Computer Science, *GPA: 4.0* — May 2013 – May 2015
Jones County Junior College - A.A.S. Information System Technology, *GPA: 4.0* — Aug 2011 – May 2013